



Move up from playing to creating

you will be hired for your work. No certificate from any school or college is going to get you into this industry. Your 98.23% in SSC will not ensure a job in this industry and neither will being an IITian. Nothing but your work can. You develop your skills, your score a nice job, you get paid handsomely, it

is that straightforward. Especially in India, unlike Engineering, there is NO standard pay scale for a Game Designer. It may range between 20k a month to more than a lakh depending on your skill. And if the very first question you ask is “What is the package?” you won’t be treated very well. It could be your second question, this industry expects passion first!

Options: Schools, Self-Learning, Mentoring?

Now then, what are your options if you want to train yourself to be a Game Designer? The good news is that there is no predetermined path to this career.

In India, your options are limited. An unbiased personal recommendation as an author of this article would be DSK Supinfogame, Pune which happens to be my alma-mater. The reason being their approach towards educating you in this craft is 100% practical. They train you via projects (that become a part of your portfolio) and by the time you graduate - you know how to work in teams and make projects possible and design really good games. Their faculty comprises professionals from western gaming industry and they seem to know what they are doing. I can’t recommend any other school (most Indian schools confuse Game Design and Game Art themselves!). Digipen, VFS and CMU are other schools abroad that will provide the kind of education that you need. Also, try to make sure the program is practical and that it is at least two years in duration.

What to avoid

1. A school that says that they will teach you Game Engines (Let’s describe these as “software/middleware used to make games”) should sound alarms. A Game Designer knows how to be resourceful enough to learn